

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Owner driving digital delivery in complex, stakeholder-dense environments.*

Positioning, ten years owning product backlogs end-to-end, from regulated platforms to B2B SaaS, with the cross-functional discipline Abu Dhabi's fast-moving digital programmes demand.

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§ WHY HALIAN

Halian's mandate here is clear: a complex, customer-focused digital product environment where backlog discipline, stakeholder translation and Agile rigour have to work in concert, not in sequence. That matches precisely the pattern across my last four engagements, regulated platforms, multi-team delivery organisations, and products where the gap between business intent and engineering execution is the core risk. The explicit call for Jira, Miro and Figma fluency, combined with preferred experience in healthcare or regulated industries, maps directly to my work at CLINET Platforms (hospital mobile app), Bundesdruckerei (national health data), and EMIL Group (insurance SaaS). *That combination of regulated-domain depth and Agile delivery rigour is where I do my most durable work.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

The role sits inside a staffing and recruiting agency context, which is not an industry I have operated in directly. The transferable mechanic that closes that gap is strong: I have spent a decade translating opaque operational workflows, procurement, insurance underwriting, clinical systems, defence data pipelines, into clean product requirements and releasable increments, which is exactly what a complex, customer-facing digital product inside a services firm demands.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec generation and edge-case drafting
- **GPT**, requirements synthesis and stakeholder document drafting
- **Lovable**, rapid UI prototyping from user story to clickable screen
- **Framer**, design-heavy workflow visualisation and stakeholder demos
- **Gamma.app**, structured roadmap and discovery decks
- **Cursor / VSCode**, reviewing and steering implementation output
- **n8n**, multi-agent workflow orchestration and automation
- **Jira**, backlog ownership, sprint tracking and release coordination

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Delivered production work across Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Terraform, GitOps pipelines, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, Dagster, dbt, Kafka, REST APIs, Docker, OpenShift, Jenkins, MongoDB, iOS and Android platforms, and Shopware; operated these stacks as product owner with enough hands-on fluency to steer architecture decisions and unblock engineering.

§ SIDE PROJECT

TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN →

A product and AI consultancy practice built to prove that one informed person with the right AI stack can replace a four-person delivery team.

- Owns the full value chain from discovery and requirements through frontend, backend and infrastructure, using coordinated multi-agent frameworks under human-in-the-loop guardrails.
- Architecture: coordinator, implementer and evaluator agents working a shared file queue, designed and operated by the candidate.
- Active client work in marketplace product design and AI-assisted operations.
- Directly relevant: demonstrates the backlog ownership, cross-functional judgment and AI-tool fluency this role requires at an accelerated pace.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT HALIAN

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow every Agile ceremony once before touching the backlog, sprint planning, refinement, stand-ups, and map the delta between what the business believes the product does and what the engineering team is actually building.

WEEK 2

Triage and re-prioritise.

Run a structured backlog audit using business value, customer impact and strategic fit as the three axes; surface the top conflicts to stakeholders with a clear recommendation rather than a list of options.

WEEK 3+

Close loops, ship.

Own the full sprint cycle end-to-end: refined stories with acceptance criteria, clear definition of done, KPI instrumentation for every shipped feature so the next prioritisation decision is driven by data rather than opinion.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team at Halian,

I am applying for the Product Owner role based in Abu Dhabi. I have spent more than ten years owning product backlogs across regulated, complex and customer-facing digital environments, insurance SaaS, national health data platforms, clinical mobile applications and AI-data pipelines for defence, and the brief in this posting describes the core challenge I am brought in to solve: turning ambiguous business needs into well-prioritised, releasable increments, while keeping engineering, design, QA and stakeholders moving in the same direction.

The regulated-industry preference in the posting is a direct match. At CLINET Platforms I shipped a hospital application across iOS and Android for multiple distinct clinical user groups and integrated it myself into the incumbent clinical system landscape. At Bundesdruckerei I owned the product for a national pandemic health data platform under the highest privacy and compliance requirements Germany operates. At EMIL Group I delivered across product

configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance and document workflow automation for insurers, reinsurers and brokers, and I built the claims module from zero with no specification, running discovery directly with a pilot customer's claim specialists. These are not adjacent experiences; they are the domain.

At EMIL I also inherited a 17-person delivery organisation that had stalled and was losing its senior engineers. I restructured it into teams with genuine end-to-end ownership. Velocity returned, client trust returned, and what had been an almost complete exodus stopped at a single departure. I mention this because the role asks for strong stakeholder engagement and cross-functional collaboration, and the hardest version of that problem is not a difficult meeting, it is a team that has stopped believing that good work changes outcomes. Repairing that is a leadership task, not a process task.

On tools: I work daily in Jira for backlog and sprint management, Miro for workflow mapping and refinement workshops, and Figma for collaborative design review with product and UX. I use AI tools, Claude, GPT, Lovable, Framr, not as novelties but as force multipliers that compress the time between a business requirement and a validated prototype.

Abu Dhabi is an explicit target location for me, not a compromise. I am prepared to relocate and to work fully on-site, and I am available within four weeks of an offer.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Philipp Hilbert is a product owner and product manager with ten-plus years of experience owning backlogs, leading Agile delivery and translating complex operational workflows into releasable software across regulated industries including insurance, healthcare, national data infrastructure and defence. He has led cross-functional teams spanning engineering, design, QA, data science and compliance, restructured stalled delivery organisations and shipped products from zero in environments with no prior specification. His working mode is AI-native: he uses current AI tools daily to compress discovery, requirements and prototyping cycles without sacrificing rigour.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Backlog ownership and sprint discipline in Scrum and SAFe environments

- Requirements elicitation and user story authoring with precise acceptance criteria
 - Stakeholder alignment across business, engineering, QA and compliance
 - Regulated-industry product delivery: healthcare, insurance, national data platforms
 - Agile ceremony facilitation: planning, refinement, stand-ups, reviews, retrospectives
 - KPI definition and instrumentation as a prioritisation input, not a reporting afterthought
 - Discovery with real users and pilot customers before committing scope
 - Cross-functional team restructuring and trust restoration in stalled programmes
 - AI-native tooling applied to requirements, prototyping and workflow automation
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

EMIL GROUP 2022

Product Manager, B2B SaaS Platform

- Delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance and document workflow automation for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.
- Built the claims module from zero with no specification, running discovery directly with pilot customer claim specialists and converting findings into user stories and acceptance criteria.
- Restructured a 17-person delivery organisation into effective cross-functional teams; restored velocity and client trust after a stall, and stopped a near-complete senior engineering exodus.
- Instrumented the claim flow so that churn per process step became the leading prioritisation metric for subsequent sprints.

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Application (iOS and Android)

- Shipped a hospital application across two platforms for several distinct clinical user groups, managing backlog, sprint ceremonies and acceptance validation end-to-end.
- Implemented the interface into the incumbent clinical system landscape directly, providing engineering-level integration knowledge to inform requirements and reduce handoff loss.
- Rationalised an overambitious roadmap to the ten percent of features with the highest patient and clinician impact, re-prioritising against user research and technical feasibility.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI 2021

Product Owner, National Health Data Platform

- Owned product requirements and backlog for secure data structures and identity management under national pandemic monitoring programmes, with the highest applicable privacy and compliance constraints.

- Ensured traceability from regulatory requirement to user story to acceptance test across each sprint cycle.

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI and Data Platform (FCAS defence programme)

- Full ownership from discovery to production: requirements, backlog, release definition and GitOps rollout for a module of the central AI backbone in a European defence programme.
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20, 40 minutes by resolving an infrastructure blocker engineering had not cracked in over a year.
- Steered a multinational team of architects, data scientists, engineers and QA across sprint ceremonies and release milestones.
- Maintained complete data provenance and audit trails for safety-critical ML training datasets, establishing compliance practice within the Agile cadence.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Data and Analytics Platform

- Owned backlog and delivery for a national analytics platform on a warehouse-grade ETL stack used by policy makers and researchers across Germany.
- Introduced automated ETL orchestration and standardised CI/CD, shortening the path from requirement to production and reducing manual release risk.
- Served as deputy IT security officer: compliance, governance and data lineage under a recurring audit cycle.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN 2020, 2021

Product Owner, Integration Team (Fuel and Convenience Retail)

- Product Owner of the integration team, downstream of research: converting research outcomes into productive, releasable integration across site and head-office systems for point-of-sale, payment and forecourt environments.
- Managed backlog ownership inside a fully SAFe organisation: PI planning, release train coordination and cross-team dependency management.
- Operated across a complex matrix organisation spanning multiple geographies and disciplines.

AOK ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Led the migration of an internal procurement platform serving roughly 20,000 employees across three regional health insurers, with catalogue and API integration into legacy systems and approval workflow configuration per organisational unit.

- Implemented a Shopware-based webshop as part of the platform migration.

CONSTRUCT8 2025, PRESENT

Product Manager, B2B Marketplace for the Construction Industry

- Zero-to-one marketplace: product vision, strategy and ongoing continuous discovery for a two-sided B2B platform matching construction firms with workers.
 - Designed the user journey across three sides, contractors, workers, and internal operations, with full AI assistance from interview through selection and vetting to minimise operational headcount.
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§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder and CFO

- Built a mobile payments platform from zero: payment service provider integration, settlement flows, onboarding and end-to-end user experience. Acquired and operated by Sparkasse.
- As CFO owned accounting, financial planning and investor reporting throughout.

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Co-Founder and Product Owner

- Co-founded and owned the product for quantum-secure encryption across a three-layer hardware and software architecture, shipped to enterprise customers under a sub-two-minute installation constraint.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES 2016, 2021

Co-Founder, CDO and CFO

- Took a nanotechnology product from laboratory to investor rounds; owned finance, HR and the ERP rollout.
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§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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RECRUITMENT AGENCY & CONTRACT STAFFING